

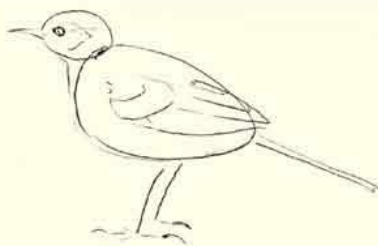
269 Sketch a bird

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Drawing an animal helps you to see it in different ways. Draw a bird, for instance, and you notice things like bill shape, color, and wing stripes. If you can't get close to a real bird, you can draw one from a photograph.

What you need

- Sketch pad or drawing paper
- Pencils for drawing and coloring



1 Draw simple ovals—a large one and a smaller one—for the body and head shapes. Add some lines to represent legs, tail, and bill.



2 Look at its size: is it fat or thin? Short- or long-legged? Is the chest plain or speckled? Are the feathers long or short?



3 Study the head. Draw in the colors and patterns around the bill and eyes. Make notes of details to fill in later.

270 Draw a flight path

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Fast wing flaps in a straight line are made by short-winged birds like ducks. Slow, steady flappers include herons, while acrobatic flight paths are made by aerial feeders like swallows.

